PROPOSAL SNAPSHOT

Team Game Proposal

SWEB451 Game Development • Weeks 2-3 Proposal Work

Proposal only. Describe the game you intend to design. Do not include a prototype, code, engine screenshots, final art, or implementation evidence at this stage.

Working title	Team name
Until We Are Ash	Synchro

Course section	Submission date	Proposal version	Team contact email
01	21/9/2026	Final	700044693@uae.ac.ae

Team Members and Proposed Responsibilities

#	Student name	Student ID	Proposed responsibility
1	Mostafa Ali	700044693	Design/development/Art/Testing
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			

Concept at a Glance

Genre or hybrid genre	Play format	Proposed platform and input
2D horror-esque platformer	singleplayer	Pc-Keyboard and mouse/controller

Game logline *Maximum 60 words*

you are tasked with exterminating a mutant plant that has taken over a facility. you slowly make your way through the increasingly overgrown facility while trying to avoid getting more infected. you must burn your way thought using a flamethrower that has limited fuel. and reach the core where you encounter the plant.

One-sentence premise *One sentence*

plunged into an infected facility, you must burn the infection at its root whilst avoiding getting burned yourself.

SECTION 1

Player and Essential Experience

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Describe the specific player and the experience you want the game to create. Avoid saying the game is "for everyone."

A. Target Player and Play Context

Primary target player *Maximum 120 words*

young-young adult players that enjoy platformers and pixel art games, as well as those who enjoy games with fluid simulation. players who enjoy short horror-Esque games.

Play context

short singleplayer meant to be played in one setting.

Input and access context

Keyboard and mouse or controller on PC.

Three design requirements created by this player profile

responsive smooth platforming mechanics
satisfying water and fire physics that are intuitive and fun.
atmospheric lighting that creates proper tension and vulnerability.

B. Essential Experience Goals

Players will feel...

initially tense/vulnerable, and later more certain and confidant

Players will think about...

how to advance to next floor.
how to balance use of resources.
planning routes while platforming.

Players will decide...

To fight or flee to save their fuel.

Explore to find extra fuel and secret rooms.

Make story-based decisions to advance the plot

Players will repeatedly do...

explore, avoid enemies, find resources, fight infection.

Observable evidence of success

Player initially moves slowly and uses limited light to clear rooms. and eventually moves more confidently thought the darkness.

Player learns to manage fuel and infection.

C. Three Design Pillars

Pillar 1

Responsive platforming mechanics

Pillar 2

satisfying water/fire mechanics

Pillar 3

using darkness effectively to create an atmosphere of tension/vulnerability. while still avoiding relying on just darkness

SECTION 2

Game Structure and Formal Elements

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Explain how the proposed game is structured. Focus on what the player does, what limits those actions, and how progress or resolution occurs.

Classification

singleplayer 2D-platformer

Why is this a game rather than only a toy or open system?

it contains a narrative that the players move forwards, as well as being governed by rules. and the player being given a goal

Formal Elements

Players and roles

player controls a character tasked with exterminating an infection that has infiltrated the facility. he is given a flamethrower with limited fuel

Objective

player must delve deeper into the facility and burn the roots of the mutant plant while avoiding enemies and potentially solving puzzles using the physics system.

Procedures and core actions

Platforming (Jump, Run, Wall jump).

Use weapon (flamethrower, switch fuel types, refuel from environment.

Infection (grows after death, makes player burn easier, changes story elements, can be cured with fire, makes you less visible to enemies).

Rules and constraints

The played can only jump once before touching the ground again.
Fuel is consumed for weapons.
Player must reach the stairs to reach next level.
Infection can only be managed by fire.

Resources

fuel and water are limited resources the player finds in the environment.

health.

infection status

Conflict and challenge

Limited fuel.
Enemies.
Darkness.
managing infection.

Boundaries

Physical walls and floor.
Plant segments block progression and must be burned.
Puzzles block progression.

Feedback

Enemies produce sound before getting within the players range of vision.
Ligh is dynamic and casts shadows that lets the player know the shape of the environment.
Infection effects player sprite, vision, and movement.

Outcome or resolution

The player wins the game after reaching the final floor and burning the plant.
The player fails if they die too many times as the infection takes over.

SECTION 3

Game Dimensions

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Use the four dimensions from Week 2 to describe the proposed world and experience. Explain design choices, not only theme or story.

Physical dimension

Space, scale, movement, perspective, spatial boundaries, and object relationships.

2D side-view perspective.

Player has simple movement abilities (Move, jump, Climb, swim).

Scale of rooms varies from claustrophobia to too large to be light up by player.

Temporal dimension

Real-time or turn-based structure, pacing, duration, timers, cycles, or time manipulation.

Real-time platformer.

game should push players to take their time exploring.

Death increases infection status

Environmental dimension

Setting, atmosphere, objects, hazards, affordances, soundscape, and interaction possibilities.

the game takes place in an evacuated infected facility.

after the first level, Darkness is more prevalent. and fire is mainly used to gain information on surrdoundings.

the atmosphere should be tense.

facility full of hazards from the plants vines.

Emotional dimension

Intended feelings, tension and relief, curiosity, confidence, surprise, mastery, or social emotion.

Player should be tense, and feel vulnerable

Darkness should also create cariosity and promote exploration.

Player should feel skilful in later levels when they master the movement mehcanics.

Interaction between dimensions

Levels vary between claustrophobic rooms that create tension and very large rooms that are impossible to light up completely and create vulnerability.

Player can place water which effects the physical layout of levels and allows more mobility.

Infection will affect enemy behaviour and force player into different playstyle.

SECTION 4

Core Gameplay Loop

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Describe one complete cycle of play. The loop should change the player's knowledge, position, risk, resources, skill, or progress.

1. Perceive	2. Decide	3. Act	4. Feedback	5. Change / progress	6. Reason to repeat
player notices progression is blocked by vines.	player decides to explore to find a way through .	player explores different rooms whilst presrving fuel.	player finds fuel, water, an alternate path, or tool improvements.	player can now go back and burn the vines blocking his path or take the altrenate path	player is encouraged to explore Keep his tank full for both exploration and self-defence, AND to progress story

Write the complete loop as a short sequence

Maximum 150 words

The player explores a floor and identifies the route to the stairs. When roots, collapsed structures, or environmental hazards block the direct path, the player chooses to spend fuel clearing it or explore a more dangerous alternate route. Exploration provides water, fuel, route knowledge, and occasional tool improvements. The player then returns, manipulates the environment with fire and water, reaches the stairs, and continues into a darker and more overgrown floor.

Most meaningful choice

Managing infection level with fire while trying to balance default and resources.

What changes after one cycle?

the player gains knowledge on how levels are structured and where he can usually find fuel and upgrades, and how to progress much faster if they have died.

Why repeat the loop?

the player is encouraged to repeat the loop to advance the plot.

Feedback Plan

Immediate response to an action

Damage from an enemy creates a slight red flash, as well as a sound effect.

When player is on fire, he becomes a light source and also creates burning sounds

How current state is communicated

The players sprite changes as they get more infected.

fire is visible on the player

How longer-term progress is communicated

Progress would be measured through the facility becoming more and more overgrown every level as player gets close to plant core.

SECTION 5

Scope and Feasibility

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Propose a small, coherent game. Separate what is essential from what can wait. A clear small scope is stronger than a long feature list.

MUST HAVE

The smallest version that preserves the core loop and essential experience.

7 levels to go with the stories' poem

Satisfying water and fire physics.

Atmospheric lighting that creates proper horror atmosphere.

Custom plant sprites to place.
Script to Burn Plants.

Appropriate music and sound effects for each level.

SHOULD HAVE

Useful additions if the core version is stable and time remains.

Revised fluid sim that can handle larger volumes of fluid without effecting performance.

More than one enemy type

Upgrades to the flamethrower

LATER / NOT NOW

Ideas intentionally excluded from the first version.

Improved sound design

More fluid types/ability to manipulate fluid viscosity

Add animation to plant sprites.

Fully animated final encounter

Constraints and Feasibility

Time and schedule

5 weeks, 2 hours average.

Team skills and availability

Limited experience in fluid simulations.
Limited art ability.

Technology, assets, and platform

Unity-pc.
NicoPardo free asset packs.
Custom made art.

Minimum proposed version

7 fully designed levels. Working fire and water. Smooth platforming controls. One enemy type. Basic sound design andmusic. Boss fight with one simple animated cutscene.

Important Assumptions to Validate Later

Assumption 1

darkness will create tension and vulnerability and encourage exploration. While also making platforming more challenging and not frustrating.

Assumption 2

Water/Fire systems can be used at scale without causing relevant performance issues.

Assumption 3

Movement controls can become as smooth and responsive as desired.

SECTION 6

Accessibility, Feedback, and Responsibility

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Plan how players will receive essential information and control the experience. Accessibility and responsible design begin during proposal work, not after implementation.

A. Planned Communication and Input Channels

- [x] Visual
- [x] Audio
- [x] Text
- [ ] Haptic
- [x] Keyboard / mouse
- [x] Gamepad
- [ ] Touch
- [ ] Voice / speech
- [ ] Other

How will critical information be available?

Most information will be provided visually through changes in player and facility sprites.
Audio cues will be used to warm of enemies and player damage.

Proposed player options

- [x] Input remapping
- [ ] Subtitles / captions
- [ ] Text scaling
- [ ] High-contrast mode
- [ ] Distinct audio cues
- [ ] Spoken feedback
- [x] Difficulty / pacing options
- [x] Pause or extra time

Audio-first or sound-led design, when applicable

Sound design will greatly improve atmosphere, helping the player become engrossed in the story.

B. Social, Cultural, Legal, and Ethical Considerations

Representation and cultural context

Gameworld and setting are purely fictional and i don't believe depict any cultural repersentations.

Player safety and responsibility

game might contain flashing lights, although easily amended through options to smooth lighting.

One concrete responsible-design action

Include a reduced-flashing option and ensure that important gameplay information is never communicated through flashing effects alone.

SECTION 7

Team Plan and Submission Check

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Agree on ownership, communication, and decision-making before production begins. Responsibilities can overlap, but each area needs a named owner.

A. Responsibility Owners

Game design and documentation	Mostafa Ali
Programming and technical integration	Mostafa Ali
Art, animation, or visual assets	Mostafa Ali,
Audio, music, dialogue, or sound-led interaction	Mostafa Ali
UI, UX, and accessibility	Mostafa Ali
Production, testing, and version/file management	Mostafa Ali

B. Collaboration Plan

Meeting rhythm

Weekly review.

Communication channel

N/A

Decision method

Testing Individual features before implementing new ones.

File and version-management plan

GitHub Desktop will mainly be used to track different builds and keep track of changes.

C. Proposal Submission Checklist

- ✔ The working title, team, genre, platform, and logline are complete.
- ✔ The target player and play context are specific enough to guide design.
- ✔ Experience goals describe what players should feel, think, decide, and do.
- ✔ Players, objective, actions, rules, resources, conflict, boundaries, feedback, and outcome are explained.
- ✔ Physical, temporal, environmental, and emotional dimensions are addressed.
- ✔ The core gameplay loop includes perception, decision, action, feedback, and change.
- ✔ Must-have, should-have, and later items show a realistic scope.
- ✔ Accessibility and communication channels are considered from the start.
- ✔ Relevant social, cultural, legal, or ethical issues are acknowledged.
- ✔ Responsibilities, collaboration, and file management have named owners.
- ✔ No prototype, code, engine screenshot, or final asset is included in this proposal.

Instructor Feedback and Decision

Instructor feedback

Decision

Instructor name / initials

Review date